

Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees

Date: March 10, 2026

Time: 6:00pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person Meeting

Present: Meaghan Schwelm, Anne Marie O'Reilly, Angela Griefen, Alison Thirkield, Rick Tracy, Deb Estelle, Jackie Brodeur
Noelle Marzullo-Kruse, Westhampton resident

Absent: None

Call To Order: 6:04 pm

Minutes from Last meeting: Approved as corrected by Rick Tracy. Motion by Deb Estelle, seconded by Angela Griefen.

Documents:

Director's Report 3.10.26

Meeting Room Policy

Social Media Policy

"Guidance relative to upcoming prop. 2-1/2 ballot question" email document, March 4, 2026, from Doug Finn.

Treasurer's Report

Building: \$3,594.48

State Aid: \$9,621.85

Deferred Town Monies (expenses): \$23,045.35

Deferred Town Monies (salaries): \$28,895.90

Gifts: \$26,982.48

Director's Report

Statistics:

Children's Programs: 11 children's programs with 126 attending

Adult Programs: 20 adult programs with 135 attending

Teen Programs: 2 teen programs with 5 attending

General Audience Programs: 0 general audience programs with 0 attending

Circulation: 1,671 (February 2025 – 1,742)

eBooks: 433 (February 2025 – 482)

Volunteer hours: 49.5

Meaghan reported that there have been some delayed deliveries from other libraries due to snow, therefore circulation numbers are down for the month.

Meaghan reported guidance from town's lawyer, emailed to the Trustees via Doug Finn, about prop 2.5 override, how town employees, boards, etc. are and are not allowed to act or speak on the issue. In summation, it is prohibited for town resources to be used to campaign or send unsolicited information, to voters who are not requesting such information.

Meaghan talked to John Chrasktko from EveryLibrary for guidance on identifying services that are core to our mission vs services that are complimentary. Discussed that we need to prioritize those core services in budget development. Core services involve serving people of all ages, including vulnerable populations, children, teens, seniors. We should refer budget items to those core services. In budget development, attempt to estimate a percentage lost affecting those vulnerable populations if an austerity budget is adopted.

Discussed scheduled Informational meetings by town finance committee about the override. Meaghan and Trustees will endeavor to attend each meeting.

Discussed the Meeting Room Policy, with suggestions for additions and adjustments. Alison Thirkield will edit Meeting Room Policy and submit draft.

Friends Report

The Friends of the Westhampton Library are writing a statement about the impact not passing the override would have on the library. Meaghan is reaching out to Doug about guidance for how they can disseminate it.

Old Business

Discussed Trustees' and Librarian's recent informational meeting with the Finance Committee regarding the FY27 budget. Cate Merlin from MBLC attended via Zoom and provided important details about MAR and state aid.

New Business

Discussed current social media policy. Social media accounts provide information and increase patronage. However, it is important to have guidelines in place about who should respond, and how, to what kinds of messages. Based upon this discussion, Alison Thirkield will draft a revised Social Media Policy and submit to the Trustees and Librarian.

Motion to adjourn by Angela Griefen, seconded by Alison Thirkield. Approved unanimously.

Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda

Meeting Adjourned: 7:12
Next Meeting: April 14, 2026
Submitted By: Alison Thirkield